

Taking ZAUQ *public*.

Everything between an invite-only app on your simulator and a listing in both stores under the company's name, in the order you have to do it, with what each step costs and how long it waits.

Prepared for Akhil. Facts checked against store documentation and current UAE and India guidance; sources at the end. This is practical guidance, not legal or tax advice: the money and licensing sections should be confirmed with an accountant in the UAE and, if you take the India route, in India.

THE SHORT VERSION

Publish under a company from day one. Open the D-U-N-S request this week, form a UAE free-zone company, then enrol both stores as an organization. Keep payments inside the stores so India works without an Indian entity.

Neither store lets you hide a personal name on an individual account, and Google cannot convert an individual account into an organization later. Doing it as a company costs roughly AED 15,000 to 25,000 in year one and adds four to eight weeks before the first submission, most of it waiting on a D-U-N-S number and a bank. Everything else in this document is the detail behind that verdict.

1. How store accounts actually work

Both stores have two kinds of account, and the kind decides three things: whose name the public sees, what you can do later, and how hard it is to change.

	APPLE DEVELOPER PROGRAM	GOOGLE PLAY CONSOLE
Cost	USD 99 per year	USD 25 once
Individual account	Your personal legal name is shown as the seller on every listing. No trade name allowed.	Your legal name, country and developer email are shown. A display "developer name" can differ, but the legal name still appears. New personal accounts must run a closed test with 12 opted-in testers for 14 continuous days before production access.

Organization account	Needs a legal entity (no DBAs, trade names or branches), a D-U-N-S number, a public website on a domain that matches your work email, and a person with legal authority to sign. The company's legal name is the seller.	Needs a D-U-N-S number and organization documents. Google shows the legal name, legal address, developer email and phone. No 14-day testing requirement.
Changing later	Apple does not convert an individual account into an organization. You enrol the company separately and transfer each app (bundle ID, reviews, ratings and update path survive; takes days per app).	Google cannot convert a personal account into an organization. You open a new organization account and transfer the app through the formal transfer process.
Selling (paid, subscriptions)	Requires the Paid Apps agreement, a bank account and a US tax form (W-8BEN-E for a UAE company; there is no US tax treaty with the UAE, which only affects the treaty section). Payouts to UAE banks are supported.	Requires a Google Payments merchant profile; the UAE has been a supported merchant country since 2014. Merchant accounts must show a full address publicly.

The consequence for you: since you don't want your name shown, the organization route is the only one that satisfies that on both stores, and it must be the first account you open, not a later migration.

2. Your options, compared

RECOMMENDED

UAE free-zone company

- Legal entity in the UAE, revenue lands in a UAE bank, matches where you live and work.
- Year one roughly AED 12,500 to 25,000 for a licence with one visa; renewals 70 to 85% of that.
- 0% corporate tax on the first AED 375,000 of profit, 9% above; Small Business Relief (revenue under AED 3M) available until 31 Dec 2026.
- Banking is the slow part: 2 to 4 weeks after the licence.

ALTERNATIVE

India private limited company

- Cheapest to form: about INR 7,000 to 25,000 all in, 5 to 20 working days through SPICe+.
- 18% GST applies on Indian customers; store payouts from Apple/Google count as export of services (zero-rated with an LUT).
- Revenue arrives in India in INR; foreign remittance paperwork (FIRC) applies.
- Makes sense only if you plan to live, hire and bank in India.

NOT SUITABLE

UAE freelance permit

- Cheap (AED 5,500 to 25,000 a year) and covers "software development", but it is a permit for a person, not a legal entity.
- Apple rejects sole proprietorships and permits for organization enrolment; your own name would still be the seller.

NOT WHAT YOU ASKED FOR

Individual accounts now, company later

- Fastest, but your name is public from the first listing and both stores force a new-account-plus-transfer later.
- Google's 14-day testing rule applies twice.

3. Forming the UAE company, step by step

A free zone is a licensing authority that lets a foreign national own 100% of a company, gives you a licence tied to named activities, and (optionally) a residence visa. For a software product sold worldwide through the stores, a free zone is the normal choice; a mainland licence adds cost and is only needed for physical trade inside the UAE.

1

Pick the free zone

YOU

IFZA and Meydan (Dubai) are the usual picks for software: packages from about AED 12,500 to 14,000 for a licence with no visa, more with visas; RAKEZ (Ras Al Khaimah) from about AED 5,500 to 14,000 for the smallest package; DMCC is the premium option at AED 35,000 to 50,000. Choose a zone whose activity list includes "software development" or "IT / application development"; the licence must say it, because the bank and Apple will read it.

2

Reserve the name

YOU

Ask for "ZAUQ" plus a suffix the zone requires (for example "ZAUQ Technologies FZCO" or "FZ-LLC"). The legal name goes on the App Store as the seller, so pick one you'd be happy to see there. Avoid words the UAE restricts (religious terms, country names, "bank", "insurance").

3

Documents

YOU

Passport, passport photo, UAE visa or entry stamp if resident, proof of address, a short business plan for some zones, and the application form. Signing is by Emirates ID or in person.

4

Licence issued

YOU

Typically 3 to 10 working days. You receive the trade licence, the Memorandum and Articles, and a share certificate. Keep PDFs of all three; every later step asks for them.

5

Establishment card and visa **YOU**

Optional if you already hold a UAE residence visa through employment; required if this company will sponsor you. Add 1 to 3 weeks and about AED 3,800 to 4,800 per visa.

6

D-U-N-S number **BOTH**

Free from Dun & Bradstreet; up to 30 working days standard, or free in about 5 business days through Apple's own request form. The company name and address must match the trade licence exactly. Start this the day the licence arrives; it is the longest wait.

7

Corporate bank account **YOU**

2 to 4 weeks. Banks want the licence, MOA, shareholder passport and Emirates ID, a lease or flexi-desk agreement (virtual offices are increasingly refused), and often the corporate tax registration number. Startups usually get the fastest answers from Wio Business or Mashreq NeoBiz; Emirates NBD, RAKBANK and Liv Business are alternatives. Minimum balances range from AED 10,000 upwards.

8

Corporate tax registration **BOTH**

Mandatory for every company with the Federal Tax Authority, regardless of size; register within three months of incorporation to avoid a fine. Elect Small Business Relief if revenue stays under AED 3M (available until 31 Dec 2026), otherwise 0% up to AED 375,000 profit and 9% above. Free-zone "qualifying income" at 0% does not normally cover consumer app sales, so plan on the 9% band once you are profitable.

9

VAT **BOTH**

Registration becomes mandatory when taxable supplies exceed AED 375,000 in 12 months (voluntary from AED 187,500). Your store income is a service supplied to Apple and Google (companies abroad), which is generally treated as an export of services; your accountant will confirm the treatment and file quarterly once registered.

10

Bookkeeping **YOU**

Corporate tax requires annual financial statements. A small firm charges roughly AED 3,000 to 8,000 a year for bookkeeping, corporate tax filing and VAT returns. Line one up when the bank account opens.

Week 1

Choose zone, reserve name, submit documents.

Week 2

Licence issued. Request D-U-N-S the same day. Apply to the bank.

Week 3–4

D-U-N-S arrives (Apple's fast path). Enrol Apple and Google as an organization.

Week 4–6

Bank account opens. Corporate tax registration. Paid-apps agreements and banking on both stores.

Week 6+

Release builds, TestFlight and Play testing, review, launch.

4. The India route, if you ever want it

You only need an Indian company if you want to bank in India, hire in India, or sell directly to Indian users from your own website. Selling through the stores does not require it (next section).

- **Forming a Pvt Ltd:** one online filing (SPICe+ on the MCA portal) bundles name reservation, incorporation, director IDs, PAN and TAN; 5 to 20 working days; INR 7,000 to 25,000 all-in including a professional. Two directors and two shareholders are needed (one can be the same person; the second can be a family member with a small holding). One director must be resident in India for 182 days a year.
- **GST:** 18% on software services sold to Indian customers; sales to customers abroad (and payouts from Apple and Google, which are foreign companies) are exports, zero-rated once you file a Letter of Undertaking each year. Register for GST from the start if you export.
- **Money coming in:** store payouts arrive as foreign remittances; the bank issues a FIRC for each, which you keep for GST and RBI records.
- **Data law:** India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act is in force with rules notified in November 2025; it applies to any app serving Indian users, Indian company or not.
- **Trademark:** INR 4,500 per class for individuals and startups (INR 9,000 for companies), 9 to 12 months to registration.

5. Can a UAE company sell to Indian users? Yes, through the stores

On both stores the customer's contract is with Apple or Google, not with you. They are the "merchant of record": they charge the Indian user in rupees, collect and remit India's 18% GST themselves, take their commission, and pay you the net in your payout currency. Google states it collects and pays GST on sales by developers located outside India; Apple does the same across its territories. India's equalisation levy that used to hit foreign digital services is gone: the 2% levy ended 1 August 2024 and the 6% advertising levy ended 1 April 2025.

The one thing to avoid: taking Indian consumers' money **outside** the stores (for example a Razorpay checkout on myzauq.com used by someone in India). That makes your UAE company a foreign supplier of "online information and database access" services, which

requires a simplified GST registration in India from the first sale, an Indian representative, and monthly returns. Keep India inside the stores until it is worth an Indian entity.

STORE COMMISSIONS TODAY

Apple: 30% standard, **15%** under the Small Business Program for developers under USD 1M in the previous calendar year (new developers qualify; you apply once enrolled).
Google: 15% on the first USD 1M and on subscriptions in most markets; since mid-2026 the EEA, UK and US split this into a 10% service fee plus a 5% billing fee. Both take their cut before your payout.

6. UAE versus India, the honest comparison

	UAE FREE-ZONE COMPANY	INDIA PVT LTD
Setup cost	AED 12,500–25,000 yr 1	INR 7,000–25,000
Time to trade	Licence in days; bank 2–4 weeks	10–20 working days; bank 1–2 weeks
Tax on profit	0% to AED 375k, 9% above; relief to end 2026	~25% effective for small companies (22% + surcharge/cess)
Consumption tax	5% VAT above AED 375k turnover; store income generally export	18% GST on Indian sales; exports zero-rated with LUT
Personal tax on dividends	None in the UAE	Taxed as income in your hands
Banking	Strict KYC, minimum balances, slow but multi-currency	Easy to open; INR only, FIRC paperwork on remittances
Ownership	100% yours, no local partner	100% yours; needs a second director/shareholder
Investors	Familiar to Gulf and international investors; many later add a holding structure	Familiar to Indian investors; SEBI/FEMA rules for foreign money
Fits you if	You live in the UAE and want revenue in AED	You move operations, team or life to India

7. Emails, accounts and who owns what

Do not create `zauq@gmail.com` for this. Apple requires the enrolling person's work email to be on the organization's own domain, Google shows the developer email publicly, and a free mailbox nobody else can recover is the single most common way founders lose an app. Use the domain you already own.

1

Company mail on myzauq.com YOU

Google Workspace Business Starter (about USD 7 per user per month) or the equivalent from your registrar. Create `founder@myzauq.com` for you, plus role addresses you will need publicly: `hello@myzauq.com` (store contact email), `support@myzauq.com` (in-app and listing support), `legal@myzauq.com` (privacy requests). Route the role addresses to your inbox.

2

Apple Account for the company YOU

Create a new Apple Account with `founder@myzauq.com`, two-factor authentication on, recovery phone set. Enrol the Developer Program with this account as the Account Holder (the one role that can accept agreements and cannot be delegated). Never enrol with your personal iCloud account.

3

Google account for the company YOU

The Workspace user `founder@myzauq.com` is already a Google account. Turn on 2-step verification (Google requires it for Play). Create the Play Console developer account from it as an organization and add a second owner later for safety.

4

Expo (EAS), Sentry, Firebase BOTH

Same company email. The EAS project holds your signing keys and push credentials; it must belong to the company account, not a personal one.

5

Domain, DNS, hosting, GitHub YOU

Move the myzauq.com registration and the GitHub repository to accounts owned by the company email (or an organization on GitHub). Add the company as the registrant contact.

6

A password manager and a written recovery sheet YOU

One shared vault (1Password or Bitwarden) holding every credential above, the D-U-N-S number, licence numbers and the tax registration numbers. Store recovery codes offline.

8. Enrolling the stores as an organization

Apple

1

Prerequisites

Legal entity, D-U-N-S number matching the licence, a public website on myzauq.com (exists), a work email on the domain, and you as a person with authority to sign (you are the owner). **YOU**

2

Enrol

From the Apple Developer app on your iPhone or developer.apple.com with the company Apple Account: choose Organization, enter the legal name and D-U-N-S, pay USD 99. Apple may phone or email to verify authority; 1 to 5 business days typically, longer if the D-U-N-S data disagrees with the licence. **YOU**

3

App Store Connect setup

Create the app record for bundle ID `com.myzauq.app`, sign the Paid Apps agreement, enter the company bank account and the W-8BEN-E, apply to the Small Business Program. **BOTH**

4

Certificates and push

I generate the distribution certificate, provisioning profile and APNs key through EAS with your one-time sign-in. **ME**

Google

1

Create the developer account

play.google.com/console with the company Google account: Organization, legal name and address exactly as licensed, D-U-N-S number, the public contact email and phone (they are shown on listings), pay USD 25. Verification asks for organization documents and can take a few days. **YOU**

2

Payments profile

Needed to sell; ties the public address to the listing. **YOU**

3

Firebase project for push

Create a Firebase project under the company Google account; I connect it to EAS for FCM. **BOTH**

I create the app, internal and closed testing tracks, and draft the Data safety and content-rating answers for your review.

ME

9. Legal and compliance before the first review

- **Privacy policy and terms** at myzauq.com/privacy and /terms, written for what ZAUQ actually does: photos of garments, full-length photos of the member, wear history, email; sent to the AI image providers, Sentry and the push services; how long kept; how to delete (in-app). Apple's privacy labels and Google's Data safety form must say the same thing, and reviewers compare them.
- **Consent**: both the UAE PDPL and India's DPDP Act want clear consent before collecting personal data and limits to the stated purpose. The Mirror's consent gate before a body photo is the right pattern; keep it.
- **Trademark "ZAUQ"**: UAE about AED 6,500 to 12,000 per class, 6 to 12 months; file in class 9 (software) and class 42 (software services) at least. Do a clearance search first; stores suspend apps on trademark complaints and that is far worse after launch.
- **Reviewer access**: the app is invite-only, so supply a demo account with a filled closet in the review notes; Apple rejects apps it cannot get into.
- **Already handled in the app**: Sign in with Apple next to Google, no external purchase links (the plan is read-only), in-app account deletion, report and block on member content, camera and photo purpose strings, encryption exemption declared.
- **Age rating**: expect 12+ (moderated member content).

10. What it costs in year one

ITEM	APPROX. COST	WHEN
Free-zone licence (no visa)	AED 12,500–14,000	Week 1
Residence visa, if the company sponsors you	AED 3,800–4,800	Weeks 2–4
D-U-N-S number	Free	Week 2
Corporate bank account	Free to open; AED 10,000+ minimum balance	Weeks 2–6

ITEM	APPROX. COST	WHEN
Apple Developer Program	USD 99 / year	Week 3–4
Google Play Console	USD 25 once	Week 3–4
Google Workspace (2 users)	~USD 14 / month	Week 1
Bookkeeping, corporate tax and VAT filings	AED 3,000–8,000 / year	Ongoing
Trademark, 2 classes, UAE	AED 13,000–24,000	Any time; sooner is safer
Expo EAS (production builds)	Free tier to start; USD 19+/month for more builds	Week 4

Free-zone prices move every quarter and packages bundle different things (desk, visas, establishment card). Get two written quotes; refuse "all-inclusive" offers that don't itemise renewal.

II. Your checklist, in order

1

Today

Set up Google Workspace on myzauq.com; create the company Apple Account and Google account with 2-factor; open a password vault. **YOU**

2

This week

Choose the free zone, reserve "ZAUQ ...", submit the application. Confirm the activity says software/app development. **YOU**

3

Licence day

Request the D-U-N-S number through Apple's form (fast path); apply to Wio Business or Mashreq NeoBiz; book an accountant. **YOU**

4

D-U-N-S day

Enrol Apple (Organization) and Google Play (Organization). Send me the Apple Team ID and the Play developer account access. **YOU**

5

Then me

Fill the Team ID and bundle IDs into the app and universal-link files, create the Firebase project link, generate signing and push credentials, produce the first preview builds for your phone, then the TestFlight and Play internal builds, screenshots, listings, Data safety and privacy label drafts, and the reviewer notes. ME

6

Bank day

Sign the Paid Apps agreement, enter banking and the W-8BEN-E on Apple; create the Google Payments profile; register for corporate tax. YOU

7

Launch

Submit for review on both. Apple 1 to 3 days typical; Google similar for a verified organization. Phased release on iOS, staged rollout on Android. BOTH

Sources

- [Apple Developer Program: become a member \(organization requirements\)](#)
- [Apple: D-U-N-S Number](#) · [Apple: enrollment help](#)
- [Individual to organization on Apple \(no conversion; transfer apps\)](#) · [App transfer keeps bundle ID, reviews, ratings](#)
- [App Store Connect: provide tax information \(W-8BEN-E\)](#) · [App Store Connect: understanding taxes \(Apple collects local taxes\)](#)
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- [Play Console: required information to create a developer account](#) · [Play Console: verifying organization accounts \(D-U-N-S\)](#)
- [Play Console: app testing requirements for new personal accounts \(12 testers, 14 days\)](#)
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- [UAE freelancer licence 2026](#) · [Freelance vs trade licence](#)
- [Register a Pvt Ltd in India 2026](#) · [Costs and timelines \(2026\)](#)
- [GST on software services and exports](#) · [LUT for zero-rated services](#) · [OIDAR compliance for foreign suppliers](#)
- [India's 2% equalisation levy abolished \(Aug 2024\)](#) · [6% levy abolished \(Apr 2025\)](#)
- [India DPDP Rules 2025 notified](#) · [UAE data protection laws \(PDPL\)](#)
- [UAE Ministry of Economy: register a trademark](#) · [UAE trademark costs and timeline 2026](#)
· [India trademark fees 2026](#)